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Follett Software

Senior Director, Software Development

Target Role: Senior Director, Software Development **Lead Record:** [`wwwworkremote` Lead #126] (<http://localhost:31000/admin/leads/126>) / [Posting #5624](http://localhost:31000/api/v0/job_postings/5624)

Company Profile: Follett Software (Chicago, IL / Remote — K–12 Education Technology, Destiny Library Platform) **Tone Calibration:** Understated, zero-fluff, honest level assessment. --- ## 1. Role Scope & Stack Analysis * **Scope:** Executive engineering director leading multiple product lines (Destiny Library Manager, Resource Manager, Accessit Library). Manages Development Managers and Senior Engineers. * **Core Technical Mandate:** Legacy modernization (Java, J2EE, .NET, JBoss, WildFly, SQL Server, jQuery → Azure cloud microservices), back-to-school peak load reliability, Spec-Driven Development, and AI workflow adoption. * **Management Burden:** Direct people management, performance coaching, succession planning, recruiting, and budget ownership across multiple product managers/teams. --- ## 2. Fit & Level Calibration (Skeptical Peer Lens) | Dimension | Target Role Expectation | Mike's Grounded Signal | Fit Status | | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | | **Technical Mandate** | Modernize legacy Java/J2EE/.NET monoliths to cloud; establish Spec-Driven workflows & telemetry. | Led OneMain Acquisition lane modernization, OpenTelemetry enterprise rollout across 36+ services, and 90-day EMR-Bear legacy audit. |  Strong Match | | **Operational Peak** | Ensure 100% uptime during high-stakes back-to-school enrollment peak. | Handled peak loan acquisition load; reduced system-wide MTTR by 60% via real-time tracing. |  Strong Match | | **Role Track** | Executive People Director (managing managers, HR reviews, budget tracking). | Principal Software Engineer / Staff Architect (Technical IC leadership; OneMain Associate Director was an IC corporate grade with no direct reports). |  Track Mismatch | | **Work Environment** | Heavy synchronous management & cross-departmental administrative meetings. | High-autonomy Principal IC track with async RFC/ADR documentation focus. |  Potential Friction | --- ## 3. Strategic Recommendation * **Primary Recommendation:** De-prioritize for IC Target Roles. * If your job search priority is a Principal IC / System Architect role with deep technical ownership and low management administrative overhead, this Senior Director post is a structural mismatch. * **Alternative Pitch (If Pursuing as Chief Architect / Principal):** If Follett is attractive as a Chicago/Remote EdTech target, do not position as a people-manager. Pitch as a **Principal Software Engineer / Chief Architect** who will partner with their

Director of Engineering to execute the multi-product legacy modernization (Java/J2EE -> microservices), enforce Spec-Driven Development standards, and safeguard back-to-school reliability.

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